

Evaluation & Awards Ecosystem

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Bottom line: Evaluations and awards are valuable. The hours spent writing, emailing, marking up and re-sending them are not. We propose a secure, AI-assisted ecosystem that **gives that administrative time back to the warfighter** and produces stronger records, piloted in the 96 MXS and built to scale across the DAF at IL4/IL5. It is also a deliberate **pathfinder**: a benchmark of how fast the DAF can take an identified gap to an MVP and IOC in an IL4/IL5 environment under today's processes, technology and regulations.

THE PROBLEM

Every quarter and every year, Airmen and Guardians rebuild their accomplishments from memory. Packages then move as PDFs by email: opened, marked up, saved and sent back at every layer. An estimated **60–80% of this work happens right at the deadline**. The know-how for a strong, promotable record lives in scattered PDFs and in a few experienced supervisors' heads. The result is lost detail, uneven quality, version confusion, and hours pulled away from the mission.

THE SOLUTION: THREE LAYERS, ONE AI ASSISTANT

- **Capture.** A year-round journal. Members log jobs, efforts, dates, impact and metrics in about 30 seconds, as work happens.
- **Context.** Each unit's rules are codified: who can apply for which award, format (e.g., 5 statements, 6 lines max), routing and suspense dates. The SEL sets it up in a **5–10 minute guided interview**, inheriting from group and wing. A **document library** of writing guides, award SOPs and sanitized past winners teaches the AI the unit's playbook.
- **Coordination.** One live package routes member > supervisor > section > flight > SEL > board, with inline comments, tracked edits, returns and full history. No email or PDF loop.
- **AI assistant.** Coaches members ("how many aircraft? what did it save?"), drafts from journal entries, checks format live, scores the *writing* against the award rubric, suggests edits, and speeds supervisor review. Every suggestion cites its source.

RESPONSIBLE AI BY DESIGN

- **Humans decide.** The AI drafts and advises and never submits. It **scores the writing, not the person**, and boards never see AI scores.
- **Traceable.** Every AI output is logged with model and prompt version and cited to its source.
- **Private by default.** A member's journal is theirs. Supervisors see only submitted packages.

A PATHFINDER FOR DAF SPEED TO CAPABILITY

We will move as fast as current policy allows and **instrument every step**, so the DAF gets a measured, repeatable path from pain point to fielded capability.

- **Benchmark the pipeline:** days from approval to IL4/IL5 environment, DevSecOps pipeline, ATO / cATO, MVP in a testable environment, and IOC.
- **Log every blocker:** each approval, handoff and wait, with owner and duration. The output is a playbook and a list of policy and process gaps.
- **Exercise the whole enterprise:** cyber and comm/IT, software factories, the AI Factory, privacy and legal, CFMs, MAJCOM and HQ, and DAF/A1 policy owners.

ROADMAP

When	Phase	Exit gate
FY27 Q1	0 · Pitch & prototype. Clickable demo on synthetic 96 MXS data.	Selected; sponsor named
FY27 Q2	1 · MVP. Journal, library, SEL setup, rules check, routing, AI coach & editor in a testable IL4 environment.	MVP live in IL4 test env
FY27 Q3	2 · IOC: 96 MXS pilot. ATO and privacy complete, one real quarterly award cycle, AI scorer & copilot.	IOC declared; benchmark report
FY27 Q4–FY28 Q1	3 · Group & wing. Nominations advance to 96 MXG and wing; dashboards; evaluation drafts.	New squadron onboarded in < 1 day
FY28+	4 · Enterprise. Other wings, both clouds, IL5 option, export to official systems.	Enterprise sponsor & sustainment

HOW WE'LL MEASURE SUCCESS

- **Mission:** admin hours returned per package (member + every reviewer) against a pre-pilot baseline; share of packages ready before the final week; emails and PDF versions eliminated.
- **DAF throughput:** days from idea to IL4/IL5 environment, to ATO, to MVP and to IOC; number of blockers and the time each one cost.

BUILT FOR DOD DEPLOYMENT

- **AWS GovCloud or Azure Government, IL4 (CUI/PII)** with an IL5 path. Kubernetes, Platform One compatible, Iron Bank, FIPS, CAC/PKI. Feeds official systems of record.

HOW THE AI FACTORY CAN HELP

1. **Sponsorship.** Accept this as an AI Factory pathfinder and help convene cyber, comm/IT, software factory, CFM, HQ and DAF stakeholders.

2. **Environment.** An IL4 development and pilot environment on the AI Factory platform (AWS GovCloud or Azure Government), with a DevSecOps pipeline.

3. **AI model access.** An approved LLM and embedding endpoint authorized for CUI/PII workloads.

4. **Accreditation & privacy.** The fastest available ATO / cATO path with control inheritance, PIA and SORN guidance, and Responsible AI review.

5. **Team.** Engineering and UX support (proposed: 2–3 developers, 1 designer, two quarters) alongside unit experts.

6. **Resourcing.** Pilot funding and compute (ROM to follow scoping).

What the 96 MXS brings: a ready pilot unit, SEL and supervisor experts, the unit's guides and SOPs, a working architecture, and a commitment to document the journey for the DAF.